

sion before transitioning to the next section, which will have a different set of chord progressions. Even if there isn't a drummer present, a good song will still have a strong sense of rhythm and have the ability to get your foot tapping along with the groove.

They begin with a drum loop and develop from there, recording fresh ideas on top of each other until they end up with a finished song. For many people, the process of songwriting is interwoven with the process of tracking, as they begin with a drum loop and grow from there. Or perhaps they have a sound collection that they navigate through using a sample finder such as Cosmos, and then they instantly begin developing new instruments to compose with by using the CR8 Sampler.

Even if this may be a different approach from that of the singer-songwriter who sits down with their instrument and notebook to scribble down some ideas for a song, the end product should nonetheless be judged in accordance with the following criteria: Is the song's melody and harmony memorable enough for it to stick in your head after it has finished playing? Does the song maintain your interest by introducing new concepts as it progresses? Does it groove?

If you had to perform the song in its most basic form, with just one instrument and a vocal (or just one instrument), would it still be a decent song? This question assumes that all other elements of the production have been removed. In that case, the other things won't really be that important. But if you can get this one perfect from the beginning, the others will fall into place with relative simplicity.

Arranging

Arranging music is one of the phases in the production of music, yet it's often the one that gets the least attention and understanding. It's always a problem with the arrangement when a song has a catchy tempo and a catchy melody, but after a while it starts to sound excessively repetitive. The arrangement of a song is what gives it its character and personality.

The arrangement of a song, in its most basic form, relates to the selection of instruments playing in each section – how they are “organised” – as well as the organisation of the sections themselves within the greater chronology of the song.

It is not sufficient to just play the verse and chorus on repeat one after the other if you have composed a superb verse and chorus. You need to find a way to weave them together. There must be some kind of accumulation of resources. For instance, the first verse merely consists of the vocal and the